11.5 NOMENCLATURE OF ORGANIC COMPOUNDS

11.5.1 Why do we need nomenclature?

In ancient days, the names of organic compounds were related to the natural things from which they were obtained. For example, the formic acid was initially obtained by distillation of 'red ants'. Latin name of the red ant is 'Formica'. So, the name of the formic acid was derived from the Latin name of its source Later, the organic compounds were synthesized from sources other than the natural sources. So scientists framed a systematic method for naming the organic compounds based on their structures. Hence, a set of rules was formulated by IUPAC **(International Union of Pure and Applied Chemistry)** for the nomenclature of chemical compounds.

11.5.2 Components of an IUPAC name

The IUPAC name of the any organic compound consists of three parts:

i. Root word

ii. Prefix

iii. Suffix

These parts are combined as per the following sequence to get the IUPAC name of the compound:



(i) Root word: It is the basic unit, which describes the carbon skeleton. It gives the number of carbon atoms present in the parent chain of the compound and the pattern of their arrangement. Based on the number of carbon atoms present in the carbon skeleton, most of the names are derived from Greek numerals (except the first four). Table 11.3 shows the root words for the parent chain of hydrocarbons containing 1to10 carbon atoms:

Table 11.3 Root words of hydrocarbons

No. of carbon atoms	Root word
1	Meth-
2	Eth-
3	Prop-
4	But-
5	Pent-
6	Hex-
7	Hept-
8	Oct-
9	Non-
10	Dec-

(ii) Prefix: The prefix represents the substituents or branch present in the parent chain. Atoms or group of atoms, other than hydrogen, attached to carbon of the parent chain are called substituents. Table 11.4 presents the major substituents of organic compounds and respective prefix used for them:

Table 11.4 Prefix for IUPAC Name

Substituent	Prefix used
-F	Fluoro
-Cl	Chloro
-Br	Bromo
-I	Iodo
$-NH_2$	Amino
$-CH_3$	Methyl
$-CH_2CH_3$	Ethyl

(iii) Suffix

The suffix forms the end of the name. It is divided into two parts such as **(a) Primary suffix** and **(b) Secondary suffix.** The primary suffix comes after the root word. **It represents the nature in carbon to carbon bonding of the parent chain**. If all the bonds between the carbon atoms of the parent chain are single, then suffix **'ane'** has to be used. Suffix **'ene'** and **'yne'** are used for the compounds containing double

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